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AIRFIELD OPERATIONS OFFICER

AFSC 13MX





CAREER FIELD EDUCATION AND TRAINING PLAN

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CAREER FIELD EDUCATION AND TRAINING PLAN

SECTION A – GENERAL INFORMATION

1. Purpose. This Career Field Education and Training Plan (CFETP) is a strategic training document that identifies life-cycle education and training requirements, training support resources, and minimum core task requirements for the Airfield Operations Officer specialty.

2. Use. 13M members, supervisors, trainers, commanders, the Development Team (DT), MAJCOM Functional Managers (MFMs), and mentors use this CFETP to ensure comprehensive training, cohesive force development, and training are available for the 13M AFSC. At the unit level, supervisors and commanders will identify, conduct, and validate training IAW this CFETP.

3. Coordination and Authority. The 13M CFM is the approval authority for the CFETP with HAF/A34A Force Development Branch as the coordinating authority. IAW DAFI36-2670, the CFM aligns under the 13M Functional Manager (FM). The 13M Functional Manager is HAF/A34 and the 13M Functional Authority is HAF/A3.

4. Roles and Responsibilities. All 13M members, supervisors, trainers, commanders, and MAJCOM staff are responsible for the knowledge and implementation of this CFETP. Each 13MX officer will complete the mandatory training requirements specified in this plan.

4.1. 334 Training Squadron. The 334 TRS manages the 13M1 Initial Skills Training (IST) course at Keesler AFB, MS. 334 TRS personnel will develop and revise formal training based upon requirements established by the users and documented in the Course Training Standard (CTS). Instructors will complete the AF Form 475, *Educational and Training Report*, to document students' performance during technical school training. For information regarding training, or the documentation of completed training, contact the 334 TRS, 13MX Training Manager, at DSN 597-5326 or Commercial 228-377-5326.

4.2. Supervisors and Airfield Operations Flight Commanders (AOF/CC) or equivalent will ensure newly assessed 13M1s are trained in accordance with this CFETP and associated documents and inform their MAJCOM Functional Managers (MFMs) & AF/A34A of trainee progress via the tracker on the 13M – USAF AO Officers MS Teams, 13M1 Upgrade Training (UGT) Channel and quarterly Training Advisory Groups (TAGs). Upon successful completion of IST & UGT, AOF/CCs will ensure an AF Form 2096 Classification/On-The-Job Training Action is prepared for signature and processed for award of 13M3 and appropriate duty title update.

4.3. MFMs will ensure Airfield Operations Officer training programs are implemented IAW this CFETP and validate 13M1 training via quarterly TAG. Any discrepancies, deficiencies, or resource constraints related to 13M training should be reported to HAF/A34A.

4.4. Commanders shall ensure 13M1s are upgraded to 13M3s within 14 months of arrival on station. Commanders shall notify the MAJCOM Functional Manager, who will in-turn notify the AFPC 13M Assignment Officer and HAF/A34A if any 13M officer cannot meet 13M3 upgrade timeline and/or performance requirements of a 13M3.

5. 13M Specialty Descriptions.

5.1. 13M Duty and Responsibility Summary. Leads Airfield Operations (AO) functions to include airfield and airspace management within national and international airspace in both peacetime, competition, and combat environments. Leads and oversees Total Force personnel, equipment, and programs including and related to Air Traffic Control (ATC; 1C1X1), Airfield Management (AM; 1C7X1), and Radar, Airfield, and Weather Systems (RAWS; 1C8X1) maintenance. Develops, formulates, and implements plans, policies, and programs for executing AO responsibilities and activities to include ensuring safe and effective aerodrome environments. Establishes standards and evaluates, trains, and advocates for organizations to manage training and execute the mission. Advises commanders on the effective and legal use of AO assets. Supports civil aviation responsibilities in compliance with Public Law 85-726. Oversees Program Element Code (PEC) funding accounts applicable to Airfield Operations and submits Program Objective Memorandum (POM) requests for funds when required.

> **Note:** Further explanation of ATC, AM, and RAWS duties and responsibilities that are encompassed in the 13M portfolio can be found in their respective CFETPs.

5.2. Entry: 13M1 (Unqualified). A core 13M officer who has not yet accomplished UGT. May or may not have completed IST. 13M1s have 14 calendar months from the Date Arrived on Station to accomplish IST and UGT and be awarded the 13M3 AFSC. 13M1s are not fully mission qualified and shall not deploy as a 13M3 nor act as a qualified Airfield Operations Officer. 13M1 AEFI shall be XL.

5.3 13M3 (Qualified). A core 13M officer who has graduated IST and completed UGT. Member may perform any qualified 13M duties (with supplemental training as dictated by duty, such as Combat Airspace). Unit-level 13Ms will have the 13M3 AFSC. 13M2 is not used.

5.4. 13M4 (Staff). A core 13M officer who has finished both IST and UGT and are performing duties while assigned to a Staff role above Wing level such as MAJCOM, NAF, Air Operations Center, Air Task Force, HAF, etc. No supplemental training is required to earn the13M4 designation. Staff positions require similar skills to those for the 13M3 AFSC, with a focus on developing operational and strategic policies, plans, and procedures.

6. Occupational Badge

6.1. The 13M Occupational Badge Heraldry. The badge's imagery represents the Airfield Operation Officer's primary environment, with the runway depicted by the sweeping center form, which raises up and fuses with the shape of a control tower cab, that often serves as a defining landmark on airfields around the world and provides homage to the foundational AFSC from which 13Ms were born (CATCO; Chief of Air Traffic Operations). The three triangles rising from the lower half denotes the aircraft dependent on Airfield Operations services, but also the three officer positions within the Airfield Operations Flight. Four stars line the runway represent the four main sections typically established in an AOF: AM (which joined the AO community in 1991), RAWS (which joined in 2014), Tower, and Radar Approach Control (RAPCON).

6.2. Occupational Badge Wear. Wear the 13M occupational badges (Basic, Senior, Master) in accordance with the below.

6.2.1. Basic: Upon graduation of UGT.

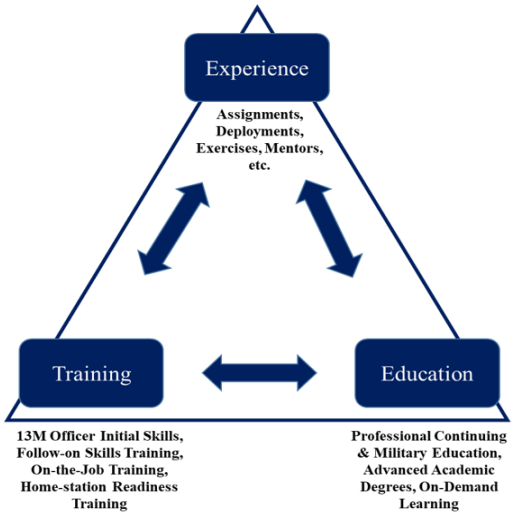
6.2.2. Senior (Basic with the star): 7 years after completion of UGT. Must also have completed one of the supplemental training courses identified in Supplemental Training.

6.2.3. Master (Basic with star and wreath): 15 years after completion of UGT. Must also have completed at least a one-year tour as either Squadron Director of Operations, Commander, or MAJCOM Functional Manager.

SECTION B – 13M DEVELOPMENT AND PROGRESSION

1. Purpose. This section provides strategic guidance for 13M development and career progression. There is no "one path" for success as an officer or 13M. Every member's career path is different, although many members meet similar milestones. Officers must continue to seek growth, education, and development outside formal training. Resources include but are not limited to professional development books/podcasts/videos, enlisted and officer mentors, the 13M Development Team (DT), advanced academic degrees, and peers.

2. Continuum of Learning (CoL). The CoL is the deliberate process of combining education, training, and experience to produce officers with the right expertise and competence to meet the Air Force's operational needs. This is the foundation for developing an Airman. (Air Force Doctrine, Annex 1-1, Force Development). Education, training, and experience are the three distinct but related force development components of the CoL. These aspects of force development are essential in developing the right person at the right time and equipping Airmen with the competencies to serve as leaders as they progress in rank and responsibility. This is an ongoing process and is continuously examined for new needs. Education and training represent a large investment of resources and are the primary tools in Airman development.



3. 13M Company Grade Officer (CGO) Progression. As CGOs, 13Ms can expect the bulk of the first 10 years of their career to be spent at the base/flight level serving as a Flight Systems Officer (AOF/SO), Flight Director of Operations (AOF/DO), and Airfield Operations Flight Commander (AOF/CC). Broadening (desired but not required) experiences for CGOs include, but are not limited to, an assignment as a technical training instructor, in-core broadening, out-of-core broadening, combat airspace experience via either an assignment or deployment to an Air Operations Center (AOC), and expeditionary experience via deployments.

4. 13M Field Grade Officer (FGO) Progression. Most FGOs have completed or are near completion of Flight Command upon promotion to Major. Some officers perform several Flight Commands and/or serve as AOF/CC as a pinned-on Major. After Flight Command, most FGOs serve in Staff positions at a MAJCOM, NAF, HAF, or Component. 13M FGOs may serve 1-3 times as a Squadron Director of Operations and may apply for Squadron Command IAW published PSDMs. Specific assignments and roles are dictated by the needs of the Air Force, A1 policy, and 13M inventory. Additionally, 13M leadership positions are highly competitive. After Squadron Command, 13M Lt Cols may also serve as Group Deputy (or equivalent).

5. O-6 Senior Officer Progression. The 13M community historically had three or less 13M-coded O-6 billets. At the time of this writing, 13M leadership is actively converting O-6 billets to 13M core positions. If not serving in a core 13M billet, Colonels typically serve as key 16G staff officers, Group Commanders, Air Base Wing Commanders, NATO liaisons, and other roles at various worldwide locations.

6. All 13M Officer Experience. The foundational experience for all 13Ms is AOF/CC. There is no "one path" to success as a 13M or officer, and AOF/CC may be served at a myriad of opportunities within one's career. Outside AOF/CC, desired, but not required, experiences for all 13Ms include, but are not limited to, service within multiple MAJCOMs, international/ICAO experience, combat airspace experience, in-core broadening (Contingency Response, AOC, etc.), out-of-core broadening (executive officer, Aide, O&IRSD, etc.). Assignments may be worldwide with specific assignments and roles dictated by the needs of the Air Force, A1 policy, and 13M inventory. Most 13Ms perform at least one short tour, with many 13Ms performing up to 3-4 short tours within a 20-year career. 13Ms can also expect to deploy multiple times throughout their career to serve as an AOF/CC, in an Air and Space Operations Center, embassy airspace liaison, in a staff function, or as a Commander.

7. Commander's Responsibilities. Commanders and supervisors must take an active role in the officer's professional development by providing mentoring and career planning. Officers should review career goals with their commander and supervisor, or senior 13Ms during frequent mentoring sessions and performance feedback sessions. Additionally, the commander will ensure the trainee and supervisor are properly resourced for successful skill-level upgrade. After upgrade, commanders should ensure proper Monthly Familiarization Time is being accomplished IAW this CFETP.

> **Note:** 13Ms are highly encouraged to use the 13M Career Progression Tool or "Ribbon Chart" found on the 13M – USAF AO Officers MS Teams, Assignment Officer Bulletin Channel to project potential milestones in both their personal and professional lives.

8. Approved Duty Titles. Officer Assignment Teams are the final approval step in MilPDS for officer duty titles. In order to streamline administrative workload, and so that 13M duty titles are standardized for ease of record assessment (especially by the Development Team), below is a list of approved core 13M duty titles. The list is not all-inclusive; minor variations may be approved with sufficient justification.

8.1. 13M Trainee

8.2. Airfield Operations Systems Officer

8.3. Airfield Operations Director of Ops

8.4. Airfield Operations Flight Commander

8.5. Director of Operations (at squadron-level)

8.6. Commander (at squadron-level)

8.7. Chief, Airspace and Ranges (or variation)

8.8. Deputy Branch Chief, [enter Branch name]

8.9. Branch Chief, [enter Branch Name]

8.10. Division Chief, [enter Division name]

SECTION C – 13M TRAINING

1. Purpose. This CFETP provides the information necessary for members, trainers, supervisors, commanders, MAJCOM Functional Managers (MFMs), and the CFM to plan, develop, manage, and conduct an effective and efficient 13M training program. The plan outlines the training that Airfield Operations Officers shall receive to develop and progress throughout their career. For purposes of this plan, training is divided into Mandatory Training and Supplemental Training.

2. Mandatory Training for 13M3

2.1. Initial Skills Training (IST). Formal course (E3OBR13M1 XXXX) conducted at Keesler AFB, Mississippi by the 334 Training Squadron. Must complete in conjunction with UGT to be awarded 13M3 AFSC.

2.2. Upgrade Training (UGT). Conducted at the first assignment before and/or after IST graduation to provide officers with the requisite foundational and technical knowledge of Airfield Operations functional areas. 13M UGT is comparable to a rated officer's airframe upgrade. UGT must be complete NLT 14 months after the member arrives on station as a new 13M1. The Airfield Operations Flight Commander is the primary point of contact who is responsible for ensuring the 13M trainee completes UGT. The trainer will ensure the trainee satisfactorily completes all required training through a combination of instructing and overseeing training from applicable offices such as ATC, AM, and RAWS. The trainer shall embed the trainee within the applicable section of the flight to the maximum extent practical, to include RAWS while the trainee is completing the RAWS QTPs (see paragraph 2.2.3.). Full immersion within each shop provides the trainee with valuable experience, a fuller understanding of AO airmen's daily lives, and a deeper knowledge of how each section runs than can be gained through pure discussion or studying. Furthermore, trainers are reminded that the point of the required certifications is to immerse the trainee within the specialty, therefore trainees should follow the facility's standard duty schedule rather than piece-meal of mixed non-training and training days. Progress will be tracked via the tracker on the 13M – USAF AO Officers MS Teams, 13M1 UGT Channel and quarterly TAGs. Paragraphs 2.2.1.-2.2.4. detail required training to be considered UGT complete and to be awarded 13M3.

2.2.1. Airfield Management Operations Coordinator (AMOC) certifications.

2.2.2. Air Traffic Control Tower Flight Data & Ground Control certifications.

2.2.3. RAWS QTPs (2023).

2.2.4. The 13M UGT Qualification Training Plan (QTP) (2021).

2.3. Follow-On Training Requirements: AFM and CCTLR PCGs must be completed within 14 months of being awarded 13M3.

3. Supplemental Training.

3.1. Purpose. Supplemental Training (ST) is encouraged and highly desired for 13Ms to learn additional skills and grow beyond the mandatory training requirements. ST is designed to broaden knowledge and skillsets which increase credibility both in and out of the career field. ST is not mandatory for skill-level upgrade but may be required for certain jobs or functions (e.g. Air and Space Operations Center, Combat Airspace duties, etc.). Below are common courses 13Ms attend; the list is not all-inclusive.

3.1.1. E3AZR1C791 00RD Advanced Airfield Manager, Keesler AFB, MS

3.1.2. E3OZR13M3 00MC, Military Airspace Management Course, Keesler AFB, MS.

3.1.3. AOCIQTFUN 000, Air Operation Center Fundamentals Course, Hurlburt Field, FL.

3.1.4. AOCIQTASP 001, Air Operations Center Initial Qualification Training Airspace Course, Hurlburt Field, FL.

3.1.5. E5AZG1C171 00FA, US Air Force Flight Procedures (TERPS), Oklahoma City, OK.

3.1.6. WCIP05A, Aircraft Mishap Investigation Course (AMIC), Kirtland AFB, NM.

3.1.7. FAA Obstruction Evaluation / Airport Airspace Analysis, Oklahoma City, OK.

3.1.8. MCADRE002, Contingency Wartime Planning Course (CWPC), Maxwell AFB, AL.

3.1.9. MCADRE003, Joint Air Operations Planning Course (JAOPC), Maxwell AFB, AL.

3.1.10. AFSC810 Safety and Accident Investigation Board President Course, Kirtland AFB, NM / Maxwell AFB, AL.

3.1.11. American Association of Airport Executive (AAAE) Courses, Various Locations.

3.2. Additional Facility Experience. 13M3s are encouraged to seek position certifications in RAPCON and Tower, and additional experience in AM, RAWS, and any other functions assigned to work center/flight/unit.

3.3. Monthly Familiarization Time (Fam-Time). Fam-Time is designed to maintain a 13M's familiarization with each facility and their Airmen within the AOF during and after UGT. After a section's qualifications have been completed, 13Ms shall accomplish the

associated fam-time for that section each month. Fam-time shall be accomplished until the member either PCS's or assumes AOF/CC duties, whichever is soonest. 13Ms are highly encouraged to continue fam-time as AOF/CC and at subsequent assignments. Fam-time is not required to be formally documented outside facility logs. Required fam-time detailed below.

3.3.1. Participate in two airfield inspections.

3.3.2. Perform two hours of ATC monitor time in each facility. 13Ms shall not be unmonitored in any position unless they have the full Control Tower Operator Certification (CTO), RAPCON Certification (RAP-C), or GCA qualifications IAW local training requirements. Monitor time will primarily be at the Watch Supervisor position but may also be conducted at other positions if operations warrant.

3.3.3. Participate in two weekly RAWS Maintenance / equipment roll-up meetings or PMIs**.**

3.3.4. Air National Guard (ANG)/AF Reserve Command (AFRC) 13M Officers should use the ANG/AFRC guidance supplements and Commander's intent to meet the intent of Fam-Time and facility familiarization.

CONCLUSION. HAF/A34A is the primary office of responsibility for the 13M CFETP and training oversight. Recommended revisions or updates can be addressed to the Branch Chief, Airfield Operations (HAF/A34A).

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BILLY R. WILSON, JR., Colonel, USAF
13M Career Field Manager

Attachments:
1. Definitions and Terms
2. 13M Career Progression Chart

ATTACHMENT 1

DEFINITIONS AND TERMS

Air Force Career Field Manager (AFCFM or CFM). Representative appointed by the respective HQ USAF Deputy Chief of Staff to ensure assigned AF specialties are trained and utilized to support AF mission requirements Air Force Officer Classification Document (AFOCD). Air Force officer specialty description outlining essential managerial, technical and professional duties.

Air Force Specialty (AFS). A basic grouping of positions requiring similar skills and Qualifications.

Career Field Education and Training Plan (CFETP). A comprehensive document that identifies life-cycle education and training requirements, training support resources and minimum requirements for each specialty.

Core Broadening (or In-Core Broadening). Special assignments or positions 13Ms can experience that hold the 13M DAFSC but are not universal experiences for 13Ms. This includes but is not limited to Contingency Response units, Combat Air Operations Squadron, Air Task Force, Air Operations Center, Combat Airspace, Air Force FAA Representative (AFREP), or Marine Exchange Assignments.

Course Training Standard (CTS). A training standard that identifies the training those members will receive in a specific course.

Initial Skills Training (IST). A formal school course that results in award of the entry-level AFS or mandatory training for upgrade to qualified officers.

Officer Instructor and Recruiting Service Duty (OI&RSD). An out-of-core broadening experience where officers may apply to be an Instructor in roles such as AFROTC, USAFA, BMT, SOS, or OTS. Recruiting Service roles are typically at Recruiting Squadrons worldwide. Applications are through formal PSDM processes.

Out of Core Broadening. Special assignments or positions 13Ms can experience that do not hold the 13M DAFSC and perform duties atypical of 13M responsibilities. Examples include but are not limited to Executive Officer, Officer Instructor and Recruiting Special Duty (O&IRSD), Commanders Action Group (CAG).

Personnel Service Delivery Memorandum (PSDM). Memorandums published on myFSS advertising opportunities and application instructions for specialized or competitive programs such as OI&RSD, Squadron Command, Language programs, etc.

Position Certification Guide (PCG). A guide developed and used to train personnel on specific knowledge and task items required for a position certification.

Qualification Training Plan (QTP). An instructional package designed for use at the unit to qualify, or aid qualification, in a duty position or program or on a piece of equipment. It may be printed, computer-based or in other audio/visual media.

Resource Constraints. Resource deficiencies, such as money, facilities, time, manpower, and equipment that preclude desired training from being delivered.

Supplemental Training (ST). Training acquired beyond the core competencies spelled out in the Qualification Training Plan (QTP).

Training Capacity. The capability of a training setting to provide training on specified requirements based on the availability of resources.

Upgrade Training (UGT). Training accomplished beyond Initial Skills Training (IST) to provide Officers with requisite foundational knowledge of Airfield Operations functional areas in order to understand the unique nature of each career field and their mission.

ATTACHMENT 2
13M Career Progression Chart

